Community strategy

Goal: Improve understanding on community strategy

Specific objectives:

- To understand the meaning and objectives of community strategy
- To define the household and community roles in community strategy
- To understand the implementation process of community strategy
- Improve knowledge on community involvement and participation in sustaining health programs
- To gain practical experience on community units

Community strategy - this is an approach that sets up an assurance that Kenyan communities have the capacity and motivation to take up their essential role in health care delivery

National Health Sector Strategic Plan – This is a five year plan that aims at reversing the declining trends in key health sector indicators. The NHSSP II has five broad policy objectives:

- Increase equitable access to health services
- Improve the quality and responsiveness of services in the sector
- Improve the efficiency and effectiveness of service delivery
- Enhance the regulatory capacity of MOH
- Foster partnerships in improving health and delivering services
- Improve the financing of the health sector

Kenya Essential Health Package of Health - KEPH is an approach that supports the achievement of the goals of the second National Health Sector Strategic Plan, 2005–2010 (NHSSP II). The packages are:

- Eliminate communicable conditions
- Revise rising burden of non-communicable conditions
- Reduce the burden of violence and injuries
- Provide essential health services
- Minimize exposure of health risk factors
- Strengthen collaboration with other related health sectors

Household – It consists of one or more people who live in the same dwelling and also share at meals or living accommodation, and may consist of a single family or some other grouping of people. A single dwelling will be considered to contain multiple households if either meals or living space are not shared.

Community mobilization – is an attempt to bring both human and non-human resources together to undertake developmental activities in order to achieve sustainable development.

Community involvement - is the process of engaging in dialogue and collaboration with community members

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Goal- is a desired result that a person or a system envisions, plans and commits to achieve. The overall goal of the community strategy is to enhance community access to health care in order to improve productivity and thus reduce poverty, hunger, and child and maternal deaths, as well as improve education performance across all the stages of the life cycle.

Objectives – the objectives of community strategy are as follows:

- To improve the health status of Kenyan communities through initiation and implementation of life-cycle focused health actions.
- Provide level 1 services for all cohorts and socio-economic groups taking in to account their priority needs
- Build the capacity of community health extension workers (CHEWs) and community own resource persons (CORPS) to provide services at level 1
- Strengthen health facility- community linkages through effective decentralization and partnership
- Strengthen the community to progressively realize their rights for accessible and quality care and to seek accountability from facility based health services

How it came about

- Communities are at the foundation of affordable, equitable and effective health care, and are the core of Kenya Essential Package for Health (KEPH)
- The concept came about after seeing the need to enhance community access to health care in order to improve productivity and reduce poverty, hunger and child & maternal dearth as well as improve education performance across all stages of the life cycle
- Kenya realized the need of establishing sustainable and decentralized community level services and accountability

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Roles of households and community

- Health promotion – through:
    - Ensure healthy diet for people at all stages in life in order to meet nutritional need
    - Building healthy social capital to ensure mutual support in meeting daily needs
    - Demand health and social entitlements as citizens
    - Monitor health status to promote early detection of problem for timely action
    - Taking regular exercise
    - Ensure gender equity
    - Use available services to monitor nutrition, chronic conditions and other causes of disability

- Disease prevention – through:
    - Practice good personal hygiene in terms of hand washing, use of latrine etc
    - Using safe drinking water
    - Ensure adequate shelter and protection against vectors of diseases
    - Preventing accidents and abuse and taking appropriate measures when they occur
    - Ensuring appropriate sexual behavior to prevent STI

- Care seeking compliance with treatment and advice – through:
    - Giving sick household members appropriate home care for illness
    - Taking children for immunization as scheduled
    - Recognizing and acting on the need for referral or seeking care outside home
    - Following recommendations given by health worker in relation to treatment, follow

up and referral
    - Ensuring that every pregnant woman receives antenatal and maternity care services

- Governance and management of health services – through:
    - Attending and taking an active part in meetings to discuss:
        - Trends in coverage
        - Morbidity
        - Resources and clients satisfaction

- Claiming rights – through:
    - Knowing what rights communities have in health
    - Building capacity to claim these rights progressively
    - Ensuring that health workers in the community are accountable for effective health service delivery and resource use
    - Ensure health facilities are functioning in line with the Citizen Health Charter

Implementation framework and process

- Organizational structure of coordination

Structure	**Summary of activities**
Household, village, school, congregation	• Plan, implement, monitor, evaluate and provide feedback on activities • Mobilize and manage resources • Undertake health promotion, hygiene, lifestyle and care seeking initiatives
Sub location, parish, dispensary	• Provide health status information • Support, provide and protect water • Manage CBHIS • Train CORPS Establish and maintain linkages
Division, health centre	• Provide training and support supervision • Coordinate, collaborate, network, pool resources
District, diocese, hospital	• Comprehensive district planning • Strengthen health boards • Facilitate M&E and coordinate NGOs • Train leaders and extension staff
Province	• Technical support

	• Build capacity of districts
National	• Formulate guidelines and policy • Build capacity of districts and province • Multi-sector and donor coordination • Ensure CBHIS is part of the HMIS • Quality assurance

- The entry steps
  - Define a clear implementation guideline
  - Create awareness among district leaders
  - Form and equip district-level multi-sector working groups and training teams
  - Follow up, monitor and evaluate
  - Launch the program in the communities. This will follow steps like:
    - Exploration
    - Protocol
    - Participatory assessment
  - The assessment should include:
    - The population
    - Community structures
    - Any existing community information systems
    - Resource availability
    - Communication strategy
    - Service delivery and the minimum package of care and support
    - Health status
    - Food security
    - The environment
- Feedback and participatory planning of level 1 service activities
  - Findings of the assessment are presented to the community in a general meeting
  - The community validates the findings
  - The community summarize the findings
  - Strategic action points are based on strengths and opportunities
  - Actions are categorized in to :
    - Those that can be taken by the CORPS
    - Those that require additional support from local partners
    - Those that require external support

Community mobilization -This is the process of bringing the community members together. It is is an attempt to bring both human and non-human resources together to undertake developmental activities in order to achieve sustainable development

- is a process through which action is stimulated by a community itself that is planned, carried out, and evaluated by a community's individuals, groups, and organizations on a participatory and sustained basis to improve the health, hygiene and education levels so

as to enhance the overall standard of living in the community

- is a process which begins a dialogue among members of the community to determine who, what, and how issues are decided,
- The process of sensitizing and motivating the community to work together
- Effective mobilization will ensure the community's interest is created and community members are motivated and influenced to take action and participate
- Mobilization is done through community gatherings, baraza, village health days, women and youth groups

Steps of community mobilization

- Getting to know the community, provide information & create interest
- Analysis + Identification resources + Problem identification + Identification solutions & projects
- Decision making & selection of leaders by community
- Identification of stakeholders
- Planning & selection of implementing leader
- Project implementation by community
- Follow-up & monitoring
- Evaluation

Tasks in community mobilization

- Developing an on-going dialogue between community members
- Creating or strengthening community organizations (Committees etc.)
- Creating an environment in which individuals can empower themselves to address their own and their community's needs
- Promoting community members' participation

Community involvement and participation - Community involvement is the process of letting the community members play active role in any activity. A project is more likely to fail if there is no community 'buy in' - Sometimes this is because the project was introduced by 'experts' who had their own ideas about what should be done. This is called the top-down approach

- Importance of community involvement and participation
  - ✓ It promote ownership and accountability
  - ✓ CORPS learn much faster when they participate
  - ✓ Community can participate in health promotion, advocacy, follow up
  - ✓ It is often better to use a participatory approach to ensure the project's sustainability
  - ✓ The participation helps to ensure that programmes are equitable and effective.
  - ✓ Participation can positively impact the health, well-being and safety.
  - ✓ Communities have different needs, problems, beliefs, practices, assets, and resources related to sexual health. Getting the community involved in program design and implementation helps ensure that strategies are appropriate for and acceptable to the community and its youth.
  - ✓ Community participation promotes shared responsibility by service providers, community members, and youth themselves for the sexual health of adolescents in the community.
  - ✓ Community participation can increase the accountability of sexual health programs and service providers.

- ✓ Participation can empower youth within the community

- Key messages to community involvement and participation
  - ✓ Special attention should be given to ensuring that all groups are able to participate, including those with specific needs and/or those who are marginalized and lacking a voice in decision-making.
  - ✓ Participation structures and procedures may require targeted effort and additional resources; it is an essential way of reinforcing a sense of dignity, reducing vulnerability and helping to build local capacity without undermining peoples' own coping strategies in times of crisis.
  - ✓ Participation should be based on assessments of existing structures which can be used to support participatory methods.
  - ✓ Participatory approaches should respect local culture there needs to be due regard for culturally-embedded power relationships which may be exploitative or oppressive.
  - ✓ Participation and community involvement should be planned and integrated into all stages of the project cycle – assessment, planning, implementation, monitoring and evaluation
  - ✓ A community's members are a rich source of knowledge about their community and of energy and commitment to that community

Procedures of community based research

- Purposes of community based research:
  - o There is increased focus of funding agencies and researchers on approaches to public health research
  - o Influence of social and political systems on behavioral and health outcomes

- Principles of community-based research:
  - ✓ Respect for community interests that go beyond those of individual potential research subjects
  - ✓ Identification of potential community stakeholders as well as individual research subjects.
  - ✓ Inform the community stakeholders and potential research subjects about the research.
  - ✓ Invite feedback regarding concerns about the research from community stakeholders and individual potential research subjects.
  - ✓ Partnership establishment
  - ✓ Respect the community partner's interest in the project and be open to ways that the community might benefit or want to use the information.
  - ✓ Disseminate research findings to both community stakeholders and individual research subjects.
  - ✓ Having the research topic address a community-defined need, question or problem, and strive to combine knowledge with action to achieve necessary changes.

  - ✓ Recognizing the research as a partnership and be open to the guidance of community insight and experience.
  - ✓ Having the partnership appropriately balance power and decision-making between the researchers and the community participants in a way that is mutually acceptable.
  - ✓ Partners making clear and open communication an ongoing priority by striving to understand each other's needs and self-interests.

- ✓ Partners recognizing race, ethnicity, class, and other aspects of culture matter and talk openly about these issues.
- ✓ Feedback among all stakeholders in the partnership, with the goals of continuously improving the partnership and its outcomes.
- ✓ Realizing partnerships can dissolve and plan a process for closure

Income generating activities

- This is a mechanism for sustainability
- The CORPS get involved in activities that give them revolving funds
- Some of the IGAs include kitchen gardening, poultry raring, merry-go-round (chama)

Skills in training a community resource person

- Adult learn best through illustrated lectures, discussions, brainstorming, group work and feedback, role plays, demonstration, community or household visit, transect walk in PRA, observation and resource mapping.
- Adult learning theory: *problem-based and collaborative*
- Principles of adult learning:
  - *Adults are internally motivated and self-directed*
    - Adult learners resist learning when they feel others are imposing information, ideas or actions on them.
    - A facilitator should:
      - Set up a *graded learning program* and do not overloading for the student.
      - *Develop rapport* with the student and show interest in their opinion
      - *Lead the student toward inquiry* before supplying them with too many facts.
      - Provide *regular constructive and specific feedback*
      - *Review goals* and *acknowledge goal completion*
      - *Encourage use of learning resources*
      - *Acknowledge the preferred learning style* of the student.

  - *Adults bring life experiences and knowledge to learning experiences*
    - ✓ Adults like to be given opportunity to use their existing knowledge and experience gained from life experience, and applies it to their new learning experiences.
    - ✓ *Find out about your student* - their interests and past experiences
    - ✓ *Assist them to draw on those experiences*
    - ✓ *Facilitate reflective learning opportunities*

  - *Adults are goal oriented*
    - ✓ Adult students become ready to learn when "they experience a need to learn it in order to cope more satisfyingly with real-life tasks or problems"
    - ✓ As educator, you can:
      - o *Provide meaningful learning experiences*
      - o *Provide real case-studies*
      - o *Ask questions* that motivate reflection, inquiry and further research.

  - *Adults are relevancy oriented*
    - ✓ Adult learners want to know the relevance of what they are learning to what they want to achieve.
    - ✓ Ways of helping learners see the value of their observations and practical experiences are:

- *Ask the student to do some reflection*
- *Provide some choice* of fieldwork project by providing two or more options, so that learning is more likely to reflect the student's interests.

- *Adults are practical*
  - ✓ Students move from classroom mode to hands-on problem solving
  - ✓ A trainer should:
    - *Clearly explain your clinical reasoning*.
    - *Be explicit*.
    - *Promote active participation*

- *Adult learners like to be respected*
  - ✓ Respect can be demonstrated to your student by:
    - *Taking interest*
    - *Acknowledging the wealth of experiences* that the student brings to the placement;
    - *Regarding them as a colleague* who is equal in life experience
    - *Encouraging expression* of ideas, reasoning and feedback at every opportunity.